

**THE FEDERAL
POLYTECHNIC, MUBI**

**DEPARTMENT OF LANGUAGES AND
COMMUNICATION**

GNS 201 COMMUNICATION IN ENGLISH I LECTURE NOTE

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GRAMMATICAL RULES

SENTENCE

A sentence is a group of words that expresses a complete thought and it usually contains a subject and predicate.

E.g. John will play today

Subject Predicate

TYPES OF SENTENCE

Sentence may be classified according to their structure or according to their function.

There are four types of sentence according to function

1. **Declarative Sentence:** This is usually used to make a statement either of fact, wish, intent or feeling.

e.g. The boy is very strong (fact)

I would like to swim (wish)

Lagos is in Nigeria (fact)

2. **Imperative Sentence.** This is used to state a command or request. Usually the subject is omitted but it is always (you)

e.g. Drive slowly (You drive slowly)

See me today (you see me today)

3. **Interrogative Sentence:** This is used to ask question and always ends with a question mark.

e.g. Who is she? Where is he reared?

4. **Exclamatory Sentence:** This is used to express strong feelings such as joy, pity, and disappointment etc.

e.g. Alas! We have arrived!

How lucky you are!

What a painful defeat!

There are also four types of sentence according to structure:

- I. The simple sentence: This contains one main clause but no subordinate clause i.e. it has a subject and predicate e.g.
The boy ran fast. Subj - the boy, predicate - ran fast.
The dog barked furiously, subj - the dog', predicate 'barked furiously'
- II. **Complex Sentence:** This is made up of one main clause and one or more subordinate clause.
- a. He failed the exam because he didn't read hard.
Main clause subordinate
- b. I don't know when she will arrive.
- c. Mary went to the market while I was reading.
- III. **Compound Sentence:** This is made up of two or more main clause.
E.g.
- a. Mary went to the market and John went to the stream.
- b. Mary went to the market, bought some oranges and gave her boyfriend.
- IV. **Compound complex Sentence:** This is made up of two or more clauses and one or more subordinate e.g.
- a. The car sped past the market and knocked down a young man when he was trying to cross the road.
- b. Mary went to the market, bought some oranges and gave her boyfriend when her mother was sleeping.

PARTS OF A SENTENCE

- I. Clause: this is a group of words that contains a verb and its subject and used as part of a sentence.
- Main or independent clause: This is a clause that can stand on its own i.e. it does not depend on any other clause. E.g.
His car was stolen when he was reading.
 - Subordinate or Dependent clause: This is a clause that cannot stand on its own but always depend on the main clause usually introduce by linking words such as that, if, where, who, how, however, although etc e.g.

His car was stolen when he was reading.

TYPES OF SUBORDINATE CLAUSES

- i. Noun Clause: This is a subordinate clause that performs the function of a noun e.g. as subject, direct object etc.
 - a. Whoever pays the fee will be admitted. (as subject)
 - b. I cannot understand why she hates me. (direct object)
 - c. That we shall pass is very obvious. (subject)
- 2 ii. Adjective Clause: This is a subordinate clause that performs the function of adjective i.e. modifying a noun or pronoun in the main clause called the antecedent.
 - a. The soldier who shot the rector was mentally deranged.
 - b. The boy whose book you stole has been expelled.
 - c. This is the house which he burnt down.
- 3 iii. Adverbial Clause: This is a subordinate clause that performs the function of an adverb in a sentence i.e. it modifies a verb, adjective or verb in the main clause.

They usually introduced by subordinating conjunctions such as before, when, because, although, since, unless, while, if, until, as soon as etc. e.g

- a. He left when I arrived (time)
- b. She passed because she read hard (reason)
- c. I was so tired that hardly slept (result)
- d. My mother knows where I keep my breads (place)
- e. She behave as if she was a preacher (manner)
- f. You will be punished if you come late (condition)

PHRASES

A phrase is a group of words which has neither a subject nor a verb and used a single part of speech i.e. it may be used as a noun, an adjective or an adverb.

TYPES:

1. Noun phrase: This is a group of words that perform the function of a noun in a sentence i.e. either as subject or object e.g.

- a. The poor are usually religious (subject)
 - b. We have abolished the obnoxious rules (object)
 - c. The labour congress has called off the strike (subject)
2. Adverbial phrase: This is a phrase that performs the function of an adverb in a sentence i.e. modifying a verb, an adjective etc. e.g.
- a. He has been here since six o'clock (duration)
 - b. He ran with great fury (adverbial-manner)
 - c. They lived near the garden (adverbial-place)
 - d. She visits him three times a week (frequency)
 - e. The match will start at three o'clock (time)
3. Adjective phrase: This is a phrase that performs the function of an adjective in a sentence i.e. it modifies a noun or pronoun etc e.g.
- a. Paul is a man of great understanding
 - b. The dog with a long tail is John's own.

Subject: This is a person or thing about which an assertion is made. E.g.

- a. The car is old.

Predicate: This is the part of the sentence that says something or makes an assertion about the subject. E.g.

- a. The car is old.
- b. They stole the mangoes.

ESSAY WRITING

There are four types of essays

- i. Narrative essays
- ii. Descriptive essays
- iii. Argumentative essays
- iv. Expository essays

- i. Narrative essays: These are essays that narrate, tell or relate stories, incidents, events or experience. These event or incidents are usually related in chronological order. Such essays are set in time and space i.e. the events take place at a particular time and in a particular place before they are narrated.

Narrative essays should be natural and should use dialogues and conversations. Short and contracted forms of words should be used freely and direct and reported speech should also be used.

- ii. Descriptive essays: Descriptive involve a vivid painting of pictures in words writing such essays, there are need to observe in detail, to see clearly, to examine critically and to watch closely. It demands the use of the senses- seeing, hearing, smelling, tasting, and touching.

Descriptive essays should be short and accurate. We should restrict our description to dominant impressions e.g. beauty, ugliness, pleasure, disgust, order, confusion, etc. scientific description should exclude personal bias and prejudice and also any personal impressions.

- iii. Argumentative essays: Argumentative are usually a kind of mini-debate. They provide training in logical thinking and fearless self expression based on a convincing, orderly and clearly presentation of thoughts.

Arguments are necessary to change existence opinions and beliefs. We should use sound reasoning to demolish our opponent's point of view. We should persuade our opponents to see with our own eyes.

Argumentative essays should be a good introduction which should lay the premise for argument. This may be in the form of definition, common sense analysis or a historical background of the subject matter.

The body of the essays should briefly state the views of the opponents. These views should then be demolished one by one. Opponent's views which are difficult to counteract should be politely

- conceded to or ignored. Use statistical data, quotations, and authorities etc. to prove your point. Make your opponent points sound unreliable or inconsistent without discourteous.
- iv. Expository essays: Such essays usually expose, expound or explain. Expository essays demands clear and logical communication. There is need to avoid muddled presentation of facts. The subject matter should be made understandable. This can be achieved by asking the question what, where, when, how and why.

Features of essays

- i. Chronological order: This has to do with time sequence e.g. morning, afternoon, evening, night, Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday, first, second, third, etc. This is useful in situations where one event leads to the other. E.g. In narrative essays and expository essays. For descriptive essays, spatial order is necessary e.g. beginning, middle, end, north, east, west, south, left, right, centre, top, bottom etc.
- ii. Logical order: This has to do with correct reasoning. Issues are normally handed from known to unknown, from seen to unseen, from specific to general, from natural to unnatural, from cause to effect etc. this approach is useful for argumentative and expository essays.
- iii. Climatic order: This has to do with arrangement of arguments in the order of increasing importance i.e. from least important to most important, from minor to major, from remote to immediate etc. The approach is useful for narrative essays.
- iv. Comparison and contrast order: This necessary for understanding. We should bring out the similarities and differences between issues. Essays should be free of personal bias or prejudice. Criticisms should be honest.

Qualities of good essays

- i. Thematic unity: Essays usually seek analyze or interpret a topic or subject. There is need to avoid deviation from the subject. We should stick only to what is relevant to the subject.
- ii. Economy of words: Essays should be short and clear. We avoid using more words than necessary. Long and familiar and technical expressions should be avoided.
- iii. Clarity: A good essay should be clear and the point. The essence of writing is to communicate and not to mystify. We should therefore be careful in order in our choice of words. We should avoid ambiguous expression.
- iv. Simplicity: Essays should be writing in a simple language. We should therefore avoid long and roundabout expressions. Use language that is within the level of the reader's comprehension.

CONNOTATION AND DENOTATION

Connotation is the use of words other than their dictionary or literal meaning. it also refers to the association that are connected to certain words or emotional suggestions related to the word, or figurative meaning of a word. Example Table the matter in the next meeting.

- She painted the town red
- My friend is the star of the team
- He is green at business
- He is the pillar of the family
- She is a snake

Denotation is the literal or dictionary meaning of a word. Example;

Profit--- gain

Broad--- wide

Difficult--- hard

LITERATURE

Literature in its broad sense is any written work. Literature can also be defined as a class of writing in which imaginative expression, aesthetic forms, universally of ideas are characteristics features.

Literature can also be defined as the entire body of writings of a specific language, period, people etc.

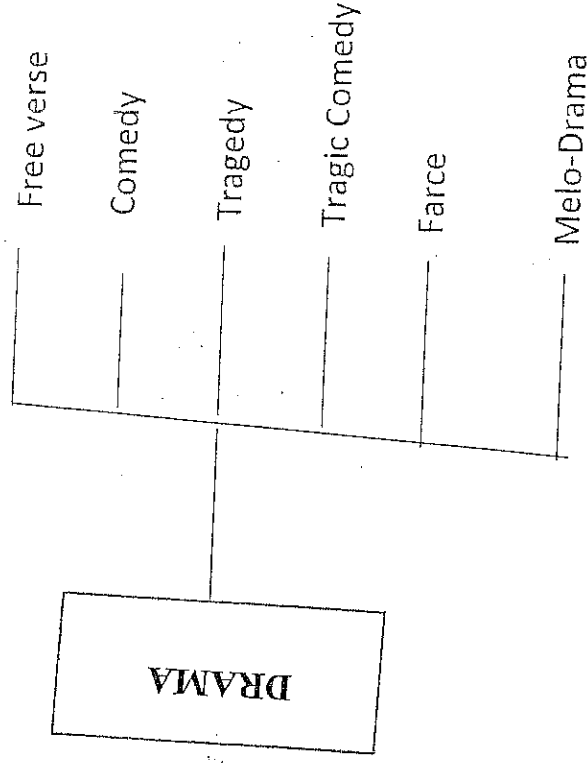
Literature is divided into three (3) genres or divisions which are: -

- a. Prose
- b. Poetry
- c. Drama

Prose: This is a type of writing that is quite close to the manner in which a person speaks, but is organized in to grammatically correct sentence and paragraphs which identify group of information that are related.

Poetry: Poems are written in lines and stanza and the use of figurative language in a rhythmic manner.

Drama: This is the oldest literary genre. Unlike prose and poetry which are in paragraphs and stanzas respectively, drama is divided into acts and scenes and is normally staged for an audience, sub-divisions of drama include: tragedy, tragic comedy farce, comedy and melo, drama.



Tragedy: A play with sad ending especially where the hero dies.

Tragic - Comedy: A play that is both funny and sad.

Drama: A play with full of exciting event which seem to exgenerated to be real.

Farce: A funny play, the theatre based of ridiculous and unlikely situations

Comedy: A play that is intended to be funny with a happy ending.

Plot: This is the series of events that make up the story

Characters: Characters are the persons in a novel play or film.

Setting: Setting is the time and place or when and where of the story. It includes the environment where the story is made, physical location, weather or social and cultural surrounding.

Act: Division of a play which is in chapters.

Theme: This is the main subject matter or topic of the story.

Connotation and Denotation

A connotation is the use of word other than their dictionary meaning it refers to the emotional suggestion related to the word or figurative meaning of a word.
e.g.

She painted the team red.

My friend is the star of the team

He is green in his business.

He is the pillar of the faculty.

She is a snake

Denotation

Profit – gain

Broad – wide

Difficult – hard

Rich wealthy purchase – buy

New – modern.

Purchase – buy